

years later, Tendulkar got his ideal send-off when he eventually pulled down the curtains, yet again, in Mumbai.

But on the night of June 6, for Chhetri, there was no one to share the burden of expectation. While all the Indian players spoke of wanting to give their skipper the perfect send-off, when the moment came, many seemed saddled by the occasion.

Heavy touches, mistimed passes, and lack of clarity with the ball cost India the fast start it usually craves. Sahal Abdul Samad, Anirudh Thapa, and Liston Colaco, all of whom have experienced high-pressure games at this venue, were unable to perform at their best.

"No, I wouldn't say so," disagreed Igor Stimac, with Gurpreet Singh Sandhu, looking shattered next to him, shaking his head in agreement. Gurpreet, who has played with Chhetri since 2011, did his part by keeping his side in the game with two brilliant saves.

Chhetri didn't want this game to be about himself and didn't mind if he didn't score. But as any striker would, he must have dreamt of having that moment one last time.

The ball was played over the

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